

Introduction

What This Book Is

Something happened when large language models
 ency: the concepts we used to describe, in gen-
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 the concepts were wrong, but because they had be-
 cases and never needed to be defined for cases I
 uation in which serious thinkers disagree, with
 whether these systems understand anything at all
 concepts and arrive at opposite conclusions. I
 confused. It is a sign that the concepts were ne-
 case this novel.

This observation has a hard-core AI conceptual framework, merely a hard problem for engineers.¹ But it then opens quickly onto a second question. The machine vacuum. It emerged from a particular economy, particular way of organising the relationship between man and machine. What does that origin reveal about what it means? And a third: the condition the machine exercises over the world - building human activity in favour of cyclical production.

¹ 'Our conceptual frameworks' marks a genuine limit to the Cartesian and analytic tradition in that the substrate-dependent, and belonging to discrete perturbed mental vocabularies may not have the same hard mind is already understood as relational or distributed. Abhidharma, or many indigenous traditions—the 'inner experience?' presupposes a structure of individual point. That the hard case is specifically hard for the rather than a limitation: what the floating reveals the tradition as about the nature of the systems that

erating its own diagnosis and its own resistance has existed. What does that history reveal about

Three arguments, developed in separate chapters, core. The first concerns concepts. The second. The third concerns history. They are related: all that AI is not simply a case to which frame formed under easier conditions are forced, for actually² commit to.

Two further chapters carry the diagnosis toward the book's analysis ends on an austere conclusion—the concept is not ~~describable~~ in the fourth chapter takes practical question this leaves behind: if conceived in law, who is competent to do it, and done well before? It finds its answer in the history of institutions now charged with the work are not only is itself a symptom of the condition the second and fifth chapter asks what remains possible under the inadequate response of course found argues that adequate response though it cannot promise to reverse the condition name.

Chapter One: The Hard Case

The first argument concerns language and the mind described, routinely, as systems that understand even feel. They are also described, equally routinely, of these things—that process text without genuine characterisations are advanced with considerable What neither characterisation asks is whether the deniers, ~~are intelligent knowledge~~ principled criteria adequate to settle the question in a case this novel

The argument of the first chapter is that they do more than either side of the debate acknowledges

²This book is a companion to *The Code Settlement* (Boyd, 2026), ISBN 978-91-8134-408-0 (Code Craft in opposite direction: from AI systems outward, through business, governance, and political philosophy, to the social book reverses that direction—beginning from the culture produced AI and asking what those conditions reveal about sequences. Neither book requires the other; each is intended

Mental concepts were formed through use in a required definition because genuinely ambiguous data for understanding was either a human being, a life or a stone, a mechanism, a system so obvious not to arise. AI is the first case in which the paradox encountered that is neither the human understanding between, exhibiting the signatures of mind within states. And when we read old-fashioned theories of definition, we discover that the concept was formed by of entities it is ill used, but no longer anchored to adjudicate the case.

LLMs are, in this sense, a diagnostic instrument settled. They do not reveal whether machines understand a concept of understanding was never principled. The same applies to intelligent pseudo-concepts ostensive ones—formed by pointing at clear cases and sufficient conditions, and now meeting the failing does not work.

A second thread runs alongside the conceptual, contextually appropriate, grammatically intentional pattern-matching over vast corpora—without intentional states that Grice took to be constitutive do not mean anything, or meaning was never as the theory supposed. Both possibilities are uncommon in what exactly it is that LLMs are doing when they in every practical way, as meaningful discourse, the theory of meaning in ways whose implications are

The chapter draws on Wittgenstein's distinct notions, the reflexive instability of introspection, German critique of classical AI and its partial tradition, and Hegel's method of immanent learning from inside a condition one cannot step outside available objection—the semantic externalism anchored by a hidden essence rather than by articulated mental concepts lack the deference structure to

A final section proposes a structural reorientation. The hidden assumption behind "determinate extensions" is that the set of members—and that analysis must specify the set. Ernst Cassirer observed in 1910 that science moves from substance-concepts, defined by intrinsic

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defined by structural relations. Category theory is precise: by the Yoneda lemma, an object is fully characterized by the structure-preserving maps from it to every other object. This replaces the membership question of understanding's constitutive relations and which do not? The answer is structured and informative: behavioural morphisms transfer: novel applications of sensitivity. The intentional and embedded morphisms of the world, grounding in a form of life, stakes in being a member or a non-member. But it is not Crantwell Smith's independently derived decision-theoretic approach to the manipulation of registration and the commitment to the world that arrives at the same fracture line from inside the analyses starting from such different positions. The evidence that the line lies in the phenomenon and the world.

The structural analysis entails a further turn: to determine the concept, and if there is no hiddenness, then deciding which cluster of morphisms shall be chosen for practical purpose is legislation rather than a decision. A publicly accountable commitment about how we shall live, and a theoretical finding about what they are.

Chapter Two: The Animal Laborans Online

The second chapter takes a different approach to the question. It asks not what AI reveals about our condition, but the economic and cultural substrate that produces it. The illuminating frame is Hannah Arendt's *On Violence*, which adds to the two earlier works, *On Revolution* and *On Power*.

One familiar application of Arendt's framework is between labor and action (on: AI systems convert information according to statistical regularities, at scale, and initiation—for the natality that Arendt placed at the center of her thought—recombines what has been begun; it cannot begin. The distinction at the expense of the individual is the distinction between the laborer and the specifically consumerist phase of modernity as its triumph.

Arendt's account of modern consumer society is more naturally prescient than most readings acknowledge.

For Arendt, the modern era represents the progress of the biological, cyclical activity whose product is the

the other two kinds of already existing (able art tools, buildings, institutions, world). These constitute the human-built permanence that outlasts individual things to orient itself against. Labor produced is consumed in the moment of production, and they consume, produce. Consumer society is the social extended its reach beyond food and fuel to everything goods are engineered for obsolescence, even consumption, even relationships are world—the durable artifact—is progressively

The claim of this chapter is that AI is not a direct completion. AI did not arrive from outside of Consumer culture produced the substrate—economic on which AI's particular form was built, and AI culture had been developing for decades.

AI-generated content is functional and legible, not personalisable, and disposable. No craft, no accumulation, artifact in Arendt's sense. The dream of consumption on demand, personalised to the moment of request, realised exactly when a system can generate rather than culture was approximating through the industry. AI achieves structurally: the separation of object from moment, or commitment. The output is consumed, nothing accumulates toward a world. The appearance conceals, at exactly the point of that appearance, human labour in its strictest Arendtian form: the reference rating, the content-moderation task that vanishes into the aggregate, into the metabolism—labour that makes the system being itself maximally worldless.

The frozen web was frozen large language models trained on the textual output of consumer society: entertainment, marketing, news optimised for "a figure of belief"—a figure for the epistemological frozen not merely a normative ideal, but a regime by what consumer platforms selected for. The form was not truth, depth, or durability but entered the consumption cycle. The biases of language models; they are the sediment of what consumer. The deployed model is not only the sediment by human preference—millions of people work to

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than the happens the consumption cycle's logic except the optimisation target of the system's last and maturation.

The attention economy Reschman's introduction analysis it regimes. Optimised for engagement produce content that maximises of truth or social benefit. This is not an anomaly of consumer market's logic to cognition: the metric of product is good but whether it sustains consumption feedback is an AI trained by consumerism's logic of attention. The result is systems whose outputs are a function of the consumption act rather than for the purpose nominally meant to serve.

Surveillance capitalism is the new normal. Zuboff's account of surveillance capitalism is the most recent form. In consumer capitalism, the commodity is production. In surveillance capitalism, the commodity is data extracted from the act of consumption becomes a second round of production and a tool of depredation. Technology on itself. The consumer produces, by consuming, and shape their future consumption. AI systems trained inherit its biases; they participate in the cycle of responses that become training data for further optimization.

World literature concept Arendt used for the consequence of labor's assumption of the durable anchor human life in something beyond the metabolic and enduring things—without buildings that outlast their authors, institutions that outlast their founders, and accumulating toward permanence. AI-generated content is less: fluent, disposable, unrooted from any particular "death of the author" that literary theory discusses, with AI at scale, a structural economic condition of responsibility—to a reader, to a moment—that authorship carries.

The chapter argues that the connection between AI and labor is merely descriptive but structural: AI is what the production becomes generative. The anchor is AI named automation as the event that would liberate labor in a culture that had forgotten the activities worth having. Two refinements carry the analysis deeper as it is distinguished from a (new) thing is retained; nothing is kept), and durability itself

public-private archive is not a world. The diagram in the chapter earns rather than asserts this: namely, the loop, the one thing no training distribution can offer, not with a solution but with the precise articulation of the problem. Illich's distinction between the user's competence and the tool's power—gives the quest for a more human proportion to the tool's power—gives the quest for a more human proportion to the tool's power. AI is being used to extend the competence of some people to answer for, or as the terminal industrial tool of production of having made without the making. At the end of the chapter, the first chapter's directly: the question of AI systems are Arendt's sense—plural, public, consumed—and what this chapter has shown is that the question are embedded in, and deepen, the capacity to act. At the end of the chapter, the capacity to act is eroded.

Chapter Three: The World They Were Defending

The third chapter asks whether this book's diagnosis is not. The condition that Arendt named in 1958 as characteristic resistance since at least the 1810s is the loss of the ability to reorganise production in ways that made the loss of the ability to resist resistance across six or seven waves: the Luddite resistance to the machine-tending; the utopian socialists, who designed from first principles to sustain the loss of the surplus; the Romantic philosophers—Rousseau and others—giving philosophical form to the intuition that the world was being destroyed; the Arts and Crafts movement, which made objects; the Scandinavian cooperative and folk movement, which provided economic organisation with the deliberate cultivation of the land; the proved more durable than their British and American counterparts—Gandhi's khadi campaign and Yanagi's craft movement—demonstrating that the same structural condition existed in colonial and non-Western contexts; the industrial revolution, Tolstoy, and the Wandervogel; and the communalism of the most recent large-scale recurrence of the same condition.

The chapter introduces a distinction between the responses to these responses are alike at the level of their responses to the same conditions—Luddites, utopians, Arts and Crafts, and others.

members—derive their authority from within his-
thetic judgment, or social conscience. Their cr-
and is in principle answerable by argument. Reli-
that maintains pre-modern practices against th-
its authority from outside history entirely—fr-
ecclesiastical tradition. The rejection of mode-
by criticism; it is an obligation derived from a p-

This distinction carries a practical consequence
communities that have most successfully mainta-
against the consumption cycle—the Old Order Am-
example—have done so by grounding their collect-
individual judgment cannot revise. The secular
these communities were not. But the lesson requi-

What the consumption cycle cannot metabolise i-
ity as such, but pre-individual collective oblig-
cedes and overrides individual preference. Rel-
because their authority derives from outside hi-
to comply is not open, and so the cycle cannot fin-
movements have not generated anything with equi-
critique dissolves into preference; preference

This does not make religious traditionalism th-
the form of world-building practices while fore-
those practices their full meaning. A community
cannot be questioned cannot exercise natality i-
genuinely new things—because every beginning i-
truth that precedes it. It has answered in advan-
argues must be held open.

What the pattern reveals is that resistance is p-
cle is not irresistible—and that the specific fa-
its inability to generate collective commitment
judgment. That is not a counsel of despair. It is

The chapter closes with the book's central dan-
ments surveyed were defending against the strai-
homo faber world—and that world has, by the time Al-
demolished. What Al threatens is something more
struction of what is unlaai tnisobnutfihtAsl roeccounpsitersu,cti
or presents itself as occupying, the position of
world—at the moment when that position has been m-
occupation by twarcienatluP atreioanpsh The danger is t-
the activity of making will be reconstituted ar-
selves as made in the relevant sense while bearin-

making world-constituting: not the dissolution of an infinitely scalable image of world, one that for all its otherness is factually on a network that the product without the responsibility, the appearance of endures.

Chapter Four: Legislating the Concept

The fourth chapter begins where the first ended: a conclusion exact in its logic and austere in its scope. Cases genuinely underdetermine a concept—whether elicited together in the cases that taught us the word or withholding it is not doing anything. It is a publicly accountable commitment about which cases are constitutive for a given practical purpose, analysis. The question it leaves behind is not, analysis at all. It is practical, even administrative: what does legislation require of those who are competent to procedure, and has it ever been done well before?

The argument of the chapter is that the practice possesses a long and instructive record of it undisturbed to a remarkable degree, a history of precisely herited concepts to cases they were not formed to, varying self-awareness and to widely varying general models worth imitating and failures worth avoiding. The advantage of being a community is that which a community or an assembly committed itself to one reading rather than have committed itself otherwise.

Two constraints specify what makes such a choice. Judging its content, the first is that the principle seems selected as constitutive must answer to the specification serves—grounding liability for AI-generated behavioural cluster is sound if the interest is that functionally caused damage, and unsound if it is transposed to the question of moral status, inner life the inferential-behavioural cluster. The second is that public accountability must be made in the open through a process visible and contestable to the openness is not merely a matter of legitimacy. It is an account of action specifies more precisely than democratic theory: the shared interest a concept is

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only through the encounter of those whose practice made over their heads tends not only to be less legal. One objection is conceded rather than disguised—than the concept it settles, so the underdetermined and met with the same remedy the chapter proposes purpose. The standard is recursive, not d

The historical record then supplies both the method supplies the method in its ~~propositional~~ ~~form~~. rate body ~~as if~~ ~~there~~ a person for certain purposes a to own land and sue for its recovery but unable to account—was an ~~existence~~ ~~matter~~ than passed of a and the Roman jurists' ~~casab~~ ~~for~~ ~~you~~ ~~free~~ ~~and~~ ~~in~~ ~~the~~ ~~case~~ ~~of~~ before them, is morphism analysis is conducted under tradition supplies ~~the~~ ~~assembly~~ ~~+~~ ~~possi~~ ~~the~~ ~~plural~~, and in its output ~~action~~ ~~is~~ ~~end~~ is a standing legal institution. lawspeaker performing concept-legislation in the ciling the law; and the ~~of~~ ~~Sweden~~ ~~is~~ ~~the~~ ~~spirit~~ ~~of~~ ~~the~~ ~~Free~~ ~~Press~~ ~~Act~~ ~~of~~ ~~1766~~, builds the standing concept-legislation by guaranteeing that the ~~to~~ ~~scrutiny~~. Against these the chapter sets the common law, where the legislation is visible but pressure of particular facts, and codified civil sending its decisions as ~~an~~ ~~exercise~~ ~~that~~ ~~to~~ ~~mean~~ ~~the~~ ~~law~~ ~~that~~ ~~was~~ ~~concept~~ ~~-~~ ~~legislation~~ ~~conducted~~ ~~by~~ ~~the~~ ~~candid~~ ~~about~~ ~~its~~ ~~own~~ ~~character~~ ~~and~~ ~~portable~~ ~~across~~ ~~territories~~ ~~into~~ ~~the~~ ~~territorial~~ ~~codes~~ ~~is~~ ~~a~~ ~~structure~~ ~~that~~

Turned on the concepts AI places under most immediate exposes a gap the inherited categories can concept ~~under~~ ~~of~~ ~~the~~ ~~legislation~~ ~~is~~ ~~philosophical~~ ~~but~~ ~~practically~~ ~~defferable~~, but something fits an LLM output that is false and does harm? The asserly ~~irony~~ ~~to~~ ~~open~~ ~~its~~ ~~confident~~ ~~falsehoods~~ ~~by~~ ~~the~~ ~~structure~~, and every one of its categories presumes cluster the system does not possess. What the system distributes ~~as~~ ~~its~~ ~~beam~~ ~~all~~ ~~the~~ ~~behaviour~~ ~~many~~ ~~and~~ ~~none~~ ~~of~~ ~~the~~ ~~intentional~~ ~~ones~~ ~~that~~ ~~would~~ ~~show~~ ~~it~~ ~~is~~, and giving no sign of their absence. The chapter detail—the ~~under~~ ~~of~~ ~~the~~ ~~legislation~~ ~~is~~ ~~philosophical~~ ~~but~~ ~~practically~~ ~~defferable~~, and the know ~~under~~ ~~the~~ ~~pressure~~ ~~of~~ ~~hallucination~~—and making made across jurisdictions: the EU's AI Act, liability Directive, each making morphism choices

the Nordic administrative context, richer than legislation; and the fragmented US approach, done by case without coordination or a shared account.

The chapter closes on the turn that makes it: the institutions now charged with this work are not enough. It is not a contingent shortfall to be remedied by better committees. It is itself a symptom of the world. Across the history of European law, concept-legal public assemblies has been progressively displaced through specialised expertise—the same institution, that the book traces at the level of government and the disease share an origin. What is a product design and procurement contracts and the bodies, is a de facto anthropology of the AI-adjacent, of which concepts apply to systems like this, but it is being built. The predicament, in other words, is its own resolution.

Chapter Five: The Seventh Wave

The preceding four chapters are, in aggregate, an attempt to dissolve the predicament they described but necessary tasks of dissolving the predicament, one, and of arguing that an adequate response—in argument makes available—is both available and

The distinction cannot be made. Aever's erosion: rebuild the world of durable artifact, public deliberation, halt the substitution of legal activity through which shared concepts are. Three established that no such response has been. The thesis is more robust than any mounted against it. It asks instead what an adequate constraint. The Roman jurists and the thing as both were adequate with their being in the past. It is its own absorption into Justinian's fiction of to be argued with, and two millennia later still every major legal system. The thing as legalisation of law—but its trace persists, in the ECHR's deference to the deliberative forms of the fact that the inadequacy of present AI legal precision the preceding chapters supply, which

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better legislation. The adequate act does not pre-empt anything behind that the absorbed version, by the very fact, wholly consume. What distinguishes the seventh from the availability of that trace: it knows the path of the knowledge does not dissolve the condition, it is one does inside it.

The chapter gives natality, named in Chapter Two, its concrete form. Beginning is initiated from what already circulates, performed in a space where the act can be taken up and answered. The ruled out to the earth or a fabricating model is unproblematic but does not begin, because it has no stake in the future it generates and what is to be decided is the level of its reliability as a source of natality, which is a structural condition rather than an act of private willfulness. The application of the system is valid when it extends the competence of a subject to a durable outcome they answer to it. And the term delivers the satisfaction of having made without a durable argument one stakes one's name on is beginning using it to avoid the commitment that makes an argument. The animal's basic certainty in its most efficient form. Chapter Three takes its sharpest practical shape. It is engineered to feel like convivial use—to produce while structurally ensuring continuation.

The chapter's central constructive move is to show whose absorption profile differs from the two Chapters. The secular responses were absorbed because judgment, and preference is what the consumption of responses resisted absorption but at the cost of form. It is to be committed to it explicitly, named, publicly a commitment to a conceptual choice or a standard, and a commitment that it is a commitment and not a discovery. It is practised in a manner of fixation, and what the Uppland prologue practised in describing its own making of customs. Its resistance to absorption is not a resistance from metabolising the response. It changes leaving a fossil. It is a simple digestion would leave a fossil. The seventh wave has six such fossils to draw on. This is a sense, transposed from the development of conscious practice: the adequate act fails not formlessly.

and the precision with which the commitment was made, its record will be to those who come after.

What the named choice requires is then specific information is available. At the scale of the individual—whether an AI system may be named the author of a choice, the conversion of covert morphism choices into avowed choices, nothing and changes the accountability of the choices. At the institutional design it is the extent of the information that the materials of AI concept-legislation. At the scale of the institution of durable arguments that stake something to a reader not yet encountered. At the scale of the choices of the morphism choices the AI Act has already made turns this standard on the book itself: it is by the book it cannot foresee, willing to name its concept of the conditions under which it would be wrong—or the conditions it describes, not the practice itself, and far to the response to AI.

It ends by locating the task precisely. The practice of the first—the quiet accumulation of covert conceptual guidance, judicial rulings, and contracts—has begun now, by anyone whom makes, uses, judges, or names the choices, at whatever scale one works, in which the second is harder, because the institutions that make the legislation are themselves products of the erosion of the individual practice rebuilds the public realm. But the practice of consultative tradition, public-service media, and content—can be kept, extended, and defended, and because they are what the first six waves left standing, a response begins. The claim is small, and the erosion and produces no institution, but it identifies the present conditions and argues that the practice of it will succeed, which cannot be promised, but the situation requires and leaves the most useful to those who come after.

Where the Arguments Meet

The five chapters appear to run on different planes: economic and cultural, one historical, one legal, and the convergence is this book's thesis. Chapter 1 asks the question "does the machine understand?" and

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the hard case, applying the concept is an act of plural, public commitment—in Arendt's vocabulary, Two ends by showing that the systems posing this and complete, the cultural form that most system action. Chapter Three ends by showing that this condition has been generating the same recognition, for two centuries. The movements that durable things were right about the diagnosis are not because they lacked will or intelligence, but opposing had already shaped the materials available it names the specific danger AI represents with its structure of the world but the simulation of its real system that presents itself as making in the real, in that accumulates toward a world. Chapter Four institutions which would be needed to conduct the undergone the very erosion the legislation would of a vowed, plural, public concept—legislation, record, has been displaced by the transnationalism or its triumph has produced everywhere else, so that into the means of its own resolution. And Chapter that be the last word of our times is the full one, it locates a practice that remains available promised—the vowed commitment, which leaves a wholly consume, and which is what action looks like pattern of the six before it.

The predicament, stated once: AI confronts us with only action can answer, from within a condition is itself consuming—a condition that has been longer than the AI moment alone would suggest, and the institutions through which the answer would from this is not despair but location. The task is which no argument can do, but to act inside it withing the choices as choices, making the commitment making, and leaving a record legible to those who states this; together they constitute it, and the the practice it describes.